

DINGYI (PENNY) PAN

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<https://pennydy.github.io/>

EDUCATION

UC San Diego, La Jolla, CA

September 2023 - Present

Ph.D. Student in Linguistics

Advisor: Andrew Kehler

Stanford University, Stanford, CA

September 2021 - June 2023

M.S. in Symbolic Systems

Thesis: “*Projection inferences with clause-embedding predicates in RSA models*”

Advisor: Judith Degen

Vassar College, Poughkeepsie, NY

August 2017 - May 2020

B.A. in Cognitive Science, Correlate in Computer Science, *Cum Laude*

Thesis: “*Are there roses in the maze?: Auditory word recognition in Mandarin-English bilinguals*”

Advisor: Janet Andrews

LSA Summer Institute, Amherst, MA

2023

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

September 2016 - June 2017, Summer 2018

Department of Linguistics

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Psycholinguistics, Pragmatics, Cognitive Science

MANUSCRIPTS AND PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

*: Equal contribution

Lu, J.*, **Pan, D.***, & Degen, J. (under review) Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island.

Pan, D., & Kehler, A. (to appear). Do Large Language Models Recognize and Utilize Non-Mandated Pragmatic Enrichments? In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Pan, D., & Bergen, B. (2025). Are explicit belief representations necessary? A comparison between Large Language Models and Bayesian probabilistic models. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Annual Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the ACL*.

Pan, D., & Degen, J. (2023). Towards a computational account of projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. In *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Pan, D. & Kehler, A. (2025). Do Large Language Models Recognize and Utilize Non-Mandated Pragmatic Enrichments? Poster to be presented at the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. San Francisco, CA.

Pan, D. & Kehler, A. (2025). Pragmatic Competence in LLMs: The Case of Eliciture. Poster to be presented at the 8th Meeting of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL). Eugene, OR.

Pan, D. & Kehler, A. (2024). Can LLMs draw conversational elicitures and put them to use? Talk presented at the 7th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 7). La Jolla, CA.

Pan, D. & Degen, J. (2024). A computational model for projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. Poster presented at the 6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 6). Stanford, CA.

Lu, J., **Pan, D.**, and Degen J. (2024). Evidence for a discourse account of Manner-of-Speaking islands. Talk presented at LSA. New York, NY.

Pan, D., & Degen, J. (2023). Towards a computational account of projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. Talk presented at the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. Sydney, Australia.

Pan, D., Lu, J., & Degen, J. (2023). Discourse Foregrounding Ameliorates Manner-of-Speaking Islands. Poster presented at HSP 2023. Pittsburgh, PA.

Pan, D., Lu, J., & Degen, J. (2023). Can Manner-of-Speaking Islands be Rescued Through Discourse Foregrounding? Short talk presented at the 5th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 5). Los Angeles, CA.

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

interActive Language Processing Lab (ALPS) , Stanford University	<i>2022 - 2023</i>
Member, PI: Judith Degen (Linguistics)	
Cognitive Science Department , Vassar College	<i>2019 - 2020</i>
Project member, Faculty mentor: Josh de Leeuw (Cognitive Science)	
Undergraduate Research Summer Institute (URSI) , Vassar College	<i>Summer 2019</i>
Member, Faculty mentor: Jonathon Gordon (Computer Science)	
Language Development and Processing Lab , University of Washington	<i>Summer 2018</i>
Summer Volunteer, PI: Akira Omaki (Linguistics)	
IMB Undergraduate Summer Workshop , University of Pennsylvania	<i>Summer 2018</i>
Attendee	
German Department , Vassar College	<i>2017 - 2018</i>
Research Assistant, Advisor: Lioba A. Gerhardi (German)	

AWARDS AND HONORS

HSP 2023 Travel Award (\$400), University of Pittsburgh	<i>2023</i>
Eloise Ellery Fellowship (\$3000), Vassar College	<i>2020</i>
<i>Phi Beta Kappa, Sigma Xi</i> , Vassar College	<i>2020</i>
<i>Psi Chi</i> , Vassar College	<i>2019</i>

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UC San Diego	
LIGN 117: The Language Code	<i>Spring 2025</i>
Instructor: Andrew Kehler	
LIGN 17: Making and Breaking Codes	<i>Winter-Fall 2024</i>
Instructor: Andrew Kehler	
LIGN 170: Psycholinguistics	<i>Summer 2024</i>
Instructor: Ebru Evcen	
Stanford University	
SYMSYS 1: Minds and Machines	<i>Summer 2022, Winter 2023</i>
Instructors: David Gottlieb (Summer 2022), Noah Goodman (Winter 2023)	
Vassar College	
CMPU 101: Computer Science I: Problem-Solving and Abstraction	<i>Winter 2019</i>
Instructor: Luke Hunsberger	
CHIN 305/306: Advance Chinese Chinese (as drill instructor)	<i>2017 - 2018</i>
Instructor: Linfeng Li	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cognitive Computing Lab, Baidu Research, Beijing
Linguistics Specialist Intern
Speech and Audio Team, ByteDance AI Lab, Beijing
Linguistics Specialist Intern

January - July 2021

May - December 2020

SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

First Language *2025*

Conference Reviewer

Cogsci *2025*

California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP) *2022 - 2023*

Conference and Event Organizing Committees

Emerging Scholar Event, Center for Research in Language (CRL), UCSD *2025*

The 7th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 7), UCSD *2024*

Departmental Service

Colloquium Committee, Department of Linguistics, UCSD *2023 - Present*

Admission Committee, Symbolic System Program, Stanford University *2023*

SKILLS

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent),
German (intermediate), Tigre (research knowledge)

Programming Languages

Python, R, Java, Scheme, Racket, Linux, C++, Javascript, HTML,
CSS, WebPPL